the Qul-i-bāyazīd's tomb. The people on the right led by Taster (bakāwal) and Jahāngīr Mīrzā, dismounted Babur's great Chār-bāgh. Nāṣir Mīrzā was leading the left wing and he chose to stopover in the meadow of Qūtlūq-qadam's tomb.

In the meantime, Babur's men repeatedly kept deliberating with Muqīm. But, while returning, they only carried excuses though at times there were words of agreement too. Perhaps his plan of bringing confusion was because he was expecting a dispatch of a courier to his father and elder brother in Qandahār post-Sherak's defeat. And perhaps he was delaying concrete actions in the hope of that dispatch.

On one very fine day, Babur ordered the party in the left, right and centre to reach close to the town by putting on their own as well as horses' mail. The order was very clear from Babur. They were supposed to display armoury to strike terror in those within. The right party under Jahāngīr Mīrzā went straight forward by the Kūcha bāgh. The centre party under Babur went along the side of Qūtlūq Qadam's tomb to a mound facing the rising ground.

As the men of Babur careered close to the Curriers' Gate showing off all the force and power they had, a bunch of fighters who had come out through it, fled away looking at the Babur's display of power. Curious Kābulīs, who had come merely to observe the happenings, could only rush away from the glacis of the citadel (*Bālā-ḥiṣār*). While they ran away, the dust rose to the heights as far as one could see. Several pits had been dug in the rise between the bridge and the gate. They were meticulously hidden and covered by plants and sticks. Sulṭān Qulī Chūnāq and several others fell prey to it easily. Soon, a few brave Kābulīs came forward, jumping from the lanes and gardens to attack with swords, but they had to face the strongest possible defence of Babur's men. Perhaps, there was no clear order of engagement and hence they soon retired without causing much damage.

When the force of Babur seemed undefendable, the perturbed Muqīm thought of sending out the offer of surrendering the town through the begs. And hence came his mediator, Bāqī Beg. He waited on Babur with fear in each breath he took. But as Babur mentioned, his fears were driven away by kindness and favour showered on him. A settlement and truce was made. As per the decisions, Muqīm was to march out with his retainers and followers handing over the town to Babur.

Bearing in mind the indisciplined acts of Khusrau Shāh's retainers, Babur appointed Jahāngīr Mīrzā and Nāṣir Mīrzā with some of the household begs, to escort Muqīm's family out of Kābul. Babur ensured that a good camping ground was assigned to him at Tipa, a place nine miles north of Kābul on the road to Āq-sarāī. But the journey wasn't going to be so easy for Muqīm and his